The colonial intent behind linguistic policies were equally reflective of the entire system of colonial education. Colonial education was offered not as an alternative to pre-existing indigenous forms of education but with the specific objective of gradually erasing their existence. The literature on the African experience with colonial education introduced by the British, especially in South Africa, tells us that colonial investment in 'educating' the colonised population had several motivations, religious not excluded, wherein the modernity/rationality complex played a significant role.[24] The coloniser's perceived sense of religious and racial superiority meant that he felt obligated to 'civilise' and 'educate' the indigenous population and 'liberate' indigenous souls from the ignorance and superstition that possessed them. In this sense, colonial education was a form of exorcism performed on the heathen native by the Christian coloniser. That apart, the more mundane and practical consideration that was couched in loftier otherworldly objectives was the need to cultivate loyalty towards the colonising empire in the short term and lay the foundations for long-term co-option and assimilation of the natives into the European way of life, albeit as second-grade human beings. Therefore, education was perhaps one of the most potent tools for cultural Europeanisation of indigenous peoples.

There was no attempt on the part of the colonial government to even hide the stated goals of colonial education, namely social engineering. Education was expressly employed to 'shape the political, social, cultural, and economic direction of the colonies'[25] and was designed to reinforce and reproduce racist structures. In short, it was an investment in a colonial future. There even exist recorded instances of European legislators in colonial South Africa exhorting the South African government to 'win the fight against the non-White in the classroom instead of losing it in the battlefield'.[26] So much for all the vaunted liberation and civilisation being benevolently offered by the coloniser through his education.

In Africa, even schools were not spared racial segregation, and it goes without saying that the schools meant for European students were better than those for African children. Expenditures and budgetary outlay for the education of White students were generally ten times higher than those for Black students.[27] Importantly, the goal of social engineering and subservience of the native society was embedded in the curriculum since the coloniser was aware of its power to 'shape the economic, social and political futures of students'.[28] Clearly, any system of colonial education was